

LOCAL GOVERNANCE AND SERVICE DELIVERY

THREE LEGS OF DEVOLUTION → TWO CONSTITUTIONAL FUNCTIONAL DOMAINS → FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO → FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARD → PLANNING INSTITUTIONS → SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 THREE LEGS OF DEVOLUTION

THREE LEGS OF DEVOLUTION OWN-SOURCE REVENUE PLUS PREDICTABLE, FORMULA-BASED TRANSFERS SUBJECTS ACTUALLY TRANSFERRED IN PRACTICE, NOT MERELY LISTED IN STAFF CONTROLLED BY AND ANSWERABLE TO THE LOCAL BODY

WITHOUT ALL THREE TOGETHER, CONSTITUTIONAL STATUS EXISTS WITHOUT DELIVERY



CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- FUNDS → own-source revenue plus predictable, formula-based transfers - FUNCTIONS → subjects actually transferred in practice, not merely listed in State law	- FUNCTIONARIES → staff controlled by and answerable to the local body, not only deputed - RULE → without all three together, constitutional status exists without delivery capacity	- FUNDS → own-source revenue plus predictable, formula-based transfers - FUNCTIONS → subjects actually transferred in practice, not merely listed in State law	- FUNCTIONARIES → staff controlled by and answerable to the local body, not only deputed - RULE → without all three together, constitutional status exists without delivery capacity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → without all three together, constitutional status exists without delivery capacity.

01

STAGE 01 TWO CONSTITUTIONAL FUNCTIONAL DOMAINS

TWO CONSTITUTIONAL FUNCTIONAL DOMAINS ARTICLE 243G WITH THE ELEVENTH SCHEDULE; TWENTY-NINE LISTED SUBJECTS THE TWELFTH SCHEDULE; EIGHTEEN MUNICIPAL FUNCTIONS URBAN LIST INCLUDES PLANNING, LAND USE, WATER, SANITATION, SOLID WASTE, PUBLIC HEALTH SHARED LIMIT

A LISTED FUNCTION IS NOT PROOF OF BUDGET, STAFF

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects	URBAN LIST INCLUDES → planning, land use, water, sanitation, solid waste, public health	RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects	URBAN LIST INCLUDES → planning, land use, water, sanitation, solid waste, public health
URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions	SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control	URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions	SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control

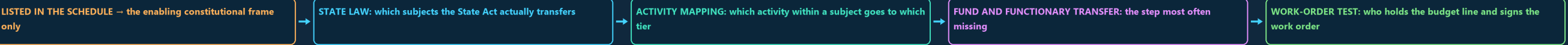
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects - URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions	- URBAN LIST INCLUDES → planning, land use, water, sanitation, solid waste, public health - SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control	- RURAL → Article 243G with the Eleventh Schedule; twenty-nine listed subjects - URBAN → the Twelfth Schedule; eighteen municipal functions	- URBAN LIST INCLUDES → planning, land use, water, sanitation, solid waste, public health - SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SHARED LIMIT → a listed function is not proof of budget, staff or agency control.

02

STAGE 02 FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO REAL CONTROL

FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO REAL CONTROL LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE THE ENABLING CONSTITUTIONAL FRAME ONLY STATE LAW WHICH SUBJECTS THE STATE ACT ACTUALLY TRANSFERS ACTIVITY MAPPING WHICH ACTIVITY WITHIN A SUBJECT GOES TO WHICH TIER FUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER



CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only - STATE LAW: which subjects the State Act actually transfers	- ACTIVITY MAPPING: which activity within a subject goes to which tier - FUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER: the step most often missing	- WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order - LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only	- STATE LAW: which subjects the State Act actually transfers - ACTIVITY MAPPING: which activity within a subject goes to which tier

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order.

03

STAGE 03 FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARD

FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARD OWN REVENUE PROPERTY TAX AND LOCAL LEVIES; NARROW BASE, OUTDATED VALUATION STATE FINANCE COMMISSION RECOMMENDS DEVOLUTION OF STATE REVENUE TO LOCAL BODIES UNION FINANCE COMMISSION

02

STAGE 02

FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO REAL CONTROL

FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO REAL CONTROLLISTED IN THE SCHEDULETHE ENABLING CONSTITUTIONAL FRAME ONLYSTATE LAWWHICH SUBJECTS THE STATE ACT ACTUALLY TRANSFERSACTIVITY MAPPINGWHICH ACTIVITY WITHIN A SUBJECT GOES TO WHICH TIERFUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER

LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only

STATE LAW: which subjects the State Act actually transfers

ACTIVITY MAPPING: which activity within a subject goes to which tier

FUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER: the step most often missing

WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only

STATE LAW: which subjects the State Act actually transfers

POWER / PROCEDURE

ACTIVITY MAPPING: which activity within a subject goes to which tier

FUND AND FUNCTIONARY TRANSFER: the step most often missing

CHECK / LIMIT

WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order

LISTED IN THE SCHEDULE → the enabling constitutional frame only

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

STATE LAW: which subjects the State Act actually transfers

ACTIVITY MAPPING: which activity within a subject goes to which tier

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WORK-ORDER TEST: who holds the budget line and signs the work order.

03

STAGE 03

FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARD

FISCAL ARCHITECTURE CARDOWN REVENUEPROPERTY TAX AND LOCAL LEVIES; NARROW BASE, OUTDATED VALUATIONSTATE FINANCE COMMISSIONRECOMMENDS DEVOLUTION OF STATE REVENUE TO LOCAL BODIESUNION FINANCE COMMISSION

ARTICLE 280(3)(BB) PANCHAYATS; ARTICLE 280(3)(C) MUNICIPALITIESTIED AGAINST UNTIED

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation	UNION FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280(3)(bb) Panchayats; Article 280(3)(c) Municipalities	OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation	UNION FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280(3)(bb) Panchayats; Article 280(3)(c) Municipalities
STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies	TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency	STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies	TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation

STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies

POWER / PROCEDURE

UNION FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280(3)(bb) Panchayats; Article 280(3)(c) Municipalities

TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency

CHECK / LIMIT

OWN REVENUE → property tax and local levies; narrow base, outdated valuation

STATE FINANCE COMMISSION → recommends devolution of State revenue to local bodies

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

UNION FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280(3)(bb) Panchayats; Article 280(3)(c) Municipalities

TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TIED AGAINST UNTIED → tied grants convert a planning authority into an executing agency.

04

STAGE 04

PLANNING INSTITUTIONS

PLANNING INSTITUTIONSDISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEEA RTICLE 243ZD; CONSOLIDATES PANCHAYAT AND MUNICIPALITY PLANS COMPOSITION RULEAT LEAST FOUR-FIFTHS ELECTED BY AND FROM THE DISTRICT'S SEATS IN PROPORTION TO THE RURAL AND URBAN POPULATION

METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEEARTICLE 243ZE; DRAFT DEVELOPMENT PLAN FOR THE METRO AREA

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans	PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district	SHARED LIMIT → constitution and effectiveness are State-variable; no compliance count	COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members
COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members	METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZE; draft development plan for the metro area	DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans	PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans

COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members

POWER / PROCEDURE

PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district

METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZE; draft development plan for the metro area

CHECK / LIMIT

SHARED LIMIT → constitution and effectiveness are State-variable; no compliance count

DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members

PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members.

05

STAGE 05

SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISION

SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISIONTHE PANCHAYATS EXTENSION TO SCHEDULED AREAS ACT, 1996APPLIES TOFIFTH SCHEDULE AREAS, NOT TO EVERY TRIBAL-MAJORITY AREAGRAM SABHAPOWERS OVER LOCAL PLANS, RESOURCES AND DISPUTE RESOLUTIONEXACT LIMIT

CONSULTATION BEFORE LAND ACQUISITION AND RESETTLEMENT, NOT CONSENT

STATUTE → the Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas Act, 1996

APPLIES TO → Fifth Schedule areas, not to every tribal-majority area

GRAM SABHA → powers over local plans, resources and dispute resolution

EXACT LIMIT → consultation before land acquisition and resettlement, not consent

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

POWER / PROCEDURE

CHECK / LIMIT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

LOCAL GOVERNANCE AND SERVICE DELIVERY • TILE 2/5 • same master rows 2208-5442 of 12064 • continues below

COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members	METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZE; draft development plan for the metro area	DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans	PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans - COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members	POWER / PROCEDURE - PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district - METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZE; draft development plan for the metro area	CHECK / LIMIT - SHARED LIMIT → constitution and effectiveness are State-variable; no compliance count - DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE → Article 243ZD; consolidates Panchayat and Municipality plans	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT - COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members - PROPORTION → seats in proportion to the rural and urban population of the district
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPOSITION RULE → at least four-fifths elected by and from the district's elected members.			

05

STAGE 05 SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISION			
SCHEDULED AREAS PRECISION	THE PANCHAYATS EXTENSION TO SCHEDULED AREAS ACT, 1996	APPLIES TO	FIFTH SCHEDULE AREAS, NOT TO EVERY TRIBAL-MAJORITY AREA
CONSULTATION BEFORE LAND ACQUISITION AND RESETTLEMENT, NOT CONSENT			
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXACT LIMIT → consultation before land acquisition and resettlement, not consent.			

06

STAGE 06 THREE DEGREES OF DECENTRALISATION			
THREE DEGREES OF DECENTRALISATION	FIELD OFFICES OF A HIGHER TIER OPERATING LOCALLY	AGENCY FUNCTIONS PERFORMED ON BEHALF OF A HIGHER TIER	TRANSFER OF AUTHORITY TOGETHER WITH RESOURCES AND ACCOUNTABILITY
DECONCENTRATION → field offices of a higher tier operating locally			
DELEGATION → agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier	DEVOLUTION → transfer of authority together with resources and accountability	FINDING → most Indian practice sits between the first two	
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - DECONCENTRATION → field offices of a higher tier operating locally - DELEGATION → agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier	POWER / PROCEDURE - DEVOLUTION → transfer of authority together with resources and accountability - FINDING → most Indian practice sits between the first two	CHECK / LIMIT - DECONCENTRATION → field offices of a higher tier operating locally - DELEGATION → agency functions performed on behalf of a higher tier	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT - DEVOLUTION → transfer of authority together with resources and accountability - FINDING → most Indian practice sits between the first two
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FINDING → most Indian practice sits between the first two.			

07

STAGE 07 DEVOLUTION CHAIN TO SERVICE OUTCOME			
DEVOLUTION CHAIN TO SERVICE OUTCOME	CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION	A PERMANENT THIRD TIER IS ESTABLISHED	STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING
STATES DIVERGE SHARPLY AT THIS STAGE			
FUNCTIONARY CONTROL	FUND DESIGN	OWN REVENUE, COMMISSION DEVOLUTION, TIED AGAINST UNTIED GRANTS	
CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established	STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage	FUND DESIGN: own revenue, commission devolution, tied against untied grants	FUNCTIONARY CONTROL: whose career does the field officer actually depend on
CAPACITY, then INTERNAL ACCOUNTABILITY: assembly, ward committee, local audit			
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established - STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage	POWER / PROCEDURE - FUND DESIGN: own revenue, commission devolution, tied against untied grants - FUNCTIONARY CONTROL: whose career does the field officer actually depend on	CHECK / LIMIT - CAPACITY, then INTERNAL ACCOUNTABILITY: assembly, ward committee, local audit - SERVICE OUTCOME: water, sanitation, roads, streetlights, records, welfare	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT - CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established - STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SERVICE OUTCOME: water, sanitation, roads, streetlights, records, welfare.			

07

STAGE 07

DEVOLUTION CHAIN TO SERVICE OUTCOME

DEVOLUTION CHAIN TO SERVICE OUTCOME

CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION

A PERMANENT THIRD TIER IS ESTABLISHED

STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING

STATES DIVERGE SHARPLY AT THIS STAGE

FUND DESIGN

OWN REVENUE, COMMISSION DEVOLUTION, TIED AGAINST UNTIED GRANTS

FUNCTIONARY CONTROL

CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established

STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage

FUND DESIGN: own revenue, commission devolution, tied against untied grants

FUNCTIONARY CONTROL: whose career does the field officer actually depend on

CAPACITY, then INTERNAL ACCOUNTABILITY: assembly, ward committee, local audit

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established

• STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage

POWER / PROCEDURE

• FUND DESIGN: own revenue, commission devolution, tied against untied grants

• FUNCTIONARY CONTROL: whose career does the field officer actually depend on

CHECK / LIMIT

• CAPACITY, then INTERNAL ACCOUNTABILITY: assembly, ward committee, local audit

• SERVICE OUTCOME: water, sanitation, roads, streetlights, records, welfare

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION → a permanent third tier is established

• STATE LAW AND ACTIVITY MAPPING: States diverge sharply at this stage

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SERVICE OUTCOME: water, sanitation, roads, streetlights, records, welfare.

08

STAGE 08

MERGER BALANCE SHEET

MERGER BALANCE SHEET

UNIFIED PLANNING ACROSS A FUNCTIONALLY CONTINUOUS SETTLEMENT

SCALE ECONOMIES IN WATER, SANITATION, SOLID WASTE AND TRANSPORT

DILUTED RURAL REPRESENTATION AND DISRUPTED LOCAL REVENUE ARRANGEMENTS

GREATER ADMINISTRATIVE DISTANCE AND LOSS OF THE VILLAGE ASSEMBLY

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement

FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport

POWER / PROCEDURE

AGAINST → diluted rural representation and disrupted local revenue arrangements

AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum

CHECK / LIMIT

FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement

FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

AGAINST → diluted rural representation and disrupted local revenue arrangements

AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement

• FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport

POWER / PROCEDURE

• AGAINST → diluted rural representation and disrupted local revenue arrangements

• AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum

CHECK / LIMIT

• FOR → unified planning across a functionally continuous settlement

• FOR → scale economies in water, sanitation, solid waste and transport

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• AGAINST → diluted rural representation and disrupted local revenue arrangements

• AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AGAINST → greater administrative distance and loss of the village assembly forum.

09

STAGE 09

DECISION RULE FOR RECLASSIFICATION

DECISION RULE FOR RECLASSIFICATION

CRITERION 1

POPULATION DENSITY TRAJECTORY AND NON-AGRICULTURAL EMPLOYMENT SHARE

CRITERION 2

INFRASTRUCTURE-SHARING POTENTIAL AND TERRITORIAL CONTIGUITY

CRITERION 3

REVENUE-BASE COMPATIBILITY AND CAPACITY OF THE RECEIVING BODY

MIDDLE OPTIONS

CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share

CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body

MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share

• CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

POWER / PROCEDURE

• CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body

• MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

CHECK / LIMIT

• CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share

• CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body

• MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities.

10

STAGE 10

URBAN FRAGMENTATION MAP

URBAN FRAGMENTATION MAP

POLITICAL LEADERSHIP

MAYOR AND COUNCIL UNDER STATE LAW

EXECUTIVE CONTROL

A STATE-APPOINTED MUNICIPAL COMMISSIONER IN MANY STATES

FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS

DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITIES AND WATER, TRANSPORT, HOUSING AGENCIES

CONSTRAINED PROPERTY TAX; MUNICIPAL BONDS ONLY FOR STRONGER BODIES

POLITICAL LEADERSHIP → Mayor and council under State law

EXECUTIVE CONTROL → a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner in many States

FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS → development authorities and water, transport, housing agencies

FINANCE → constrained property tax; municipal bonds only for stronger bodies

CONSEQUENCE → responsibility without matching authority at the elected tier

CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body

MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share
- CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

POWER / PROCEDURE

- CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body
- MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

CHECK / LIMIT

- CRITERION 1 → population density trajectory and non-agricultural employment share
- CRITERION 2 → infrastructure-sharing potential and territorial contiguity

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CRITERION 3 → revenue-base compatibility and capacity of the receiving body
- MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MIDDLE OPTIONS → service-level convergence, graduated reclassification, joint authorities.

10

STAGE 10

URBAN FRAGMENTATION MAP

URBAN FRAGMENTATION MAP

POLITICAL LEADERSHIP

MAYOR AND COUNCIL UNDER STATE LAW

EXECUTIVE CONTROL

A STATE-APPOINTED MUNICIPAL COMMISSIONER IN MANY STATES

FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS

DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITIES AND WATER, TRANSPORT, HOUSING AGENCIES

CONSTRAINED PROPERTY TAX; MUNICIPAL BONDS ONLY FOR STRONGER BODIES

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CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- POLITICAL LEADERSHIP → Mayor and council under State law
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POWER / PROCEDURE

- FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS → development authorities and water, transport, housing agencies
- FINANCE → constrained property tax; municipal bonds only for stronger bodies

CHECK / LIMIT

- CONSEQUENCE → responsibility without matching authority at the elected tier
- POLITICAL LEADERSHIP → Mayor and council under State law

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- EXECUTIVE CONTROL → a State-appointed Municipal Commissioner in many States
- FUNCTIONS AND BUDGETS → development authorities and water, transport, housing agencies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSEQUENCE → responsibility without matching authority at the elected tier.

11

STAGE 11

ANSWER SPINE FOR A LOCAL-GOVERNANCE DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A LOCAL-GOVERNANCE DEMAND

THE THREE LEGS, NOT THE AMENDMENT; DELIVERY CAPACITY, NOT

TRACE ONE SERVICE FROM LISTED SUBJECT TO WORK ORDER

LABEL ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES SEPARATELY AND GIVE A CRITERIA-BASED

GRADED VERDICT ON REPRESENTATION AGAINST AUTHORITY WITH STATE VARIATION

OPEN → the three legs, not the amendment; delivery capacity, not constitutional recital

BUILD → trace one service from listed subject to work order and name where it stops

CORRECT → label advantages and disadvantages separately and give a criteria-based rule

CLOSE → graded verdict on representation against authority with State variation stated

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- OPEN → the three legs, not the amendment; delivery capacity, not constitutional recital
- BUILD → trace one service from listed subject to work order and name where it stops

POWER / PROCEDURE

- CORRECT → label advantages and disadvantages separately and give a criteria-based rule
- CLOSE → graded verdict on representation against authority with State variation stated

CHECK / LIMIT

- OPEN → the three legs, not the amendment; delivery capacity, not constitutional recital
- BUILD → trace one service from listed subject to work order and name where it stops

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CORRECT → label advantages and disadvantages separately and give a criteria-based rule
- CLOSE → graded verdict on representation against authority with State variation stated

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict on representation against authority with State variation stated.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

RURAL-URBAN MERGER DECISIONS ARE BEST EVALUATED USING EXPLICIT CRITERIA

THE DEVOLUTION-GAP DIAGNOSTIC ALSO EXPLAINS WHY INDIA'S GOOD GOVERNANCE

FUNCTIONARY-CONTROL GAPS INTERSECT WITH THE CIVIL-SERVICES GENERALIST-SPECIALIST DEBATE

DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEES ARE THE CONSTITUTIONALLY MANDATED CONSOLIDATION MECHANISM

ARTICLE 243ZD'S FOUR-FIFTHS ELECTED-MEMBER RULE AND COMMON-INTEREST PLANNING FACTORS

THE MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ DEVOLUTION INDEX REPORT 2024

STATE FINANCE COMMISSIONS ARE THE CONSTITUTIONALLY MANDATED MECHANISM (COMPOSITION/

OPTIONAL INSTITUTIONAL DEPTH

- CAUTION: Rural-urban merger decisions are best evaluated using explicit criteria — population
- CAUTION: The devolution-gap diagnostic also explains why India's Good Governance Index (01)
- CAUTION: Functionary-control gaps intersect with the civil-services generalist-specialist debate
- District Planning Committees are the constitutionally mandated consolidation mechanism

STATUS / DATA CLAIM LIMIT

- Article 243ZD's four-fifths elected-member rule and common-interest planning factors make
- The Ministry of Panchayati Raj Devolution Index Report 2024 provides a current,
- State Finance Commissions are the constitutionally mandated mechanism (composition/
- CAUTION: Kerala's continuing institutional practice (post-1996) of protecting the devolved plan

COMPARATIVE GOVERNANCE NUANCE

- CAUTION: A rapidly urbanising Gram Panchayat on a metropolitan periphery facing traffic, water and
- CAUTION: Boundary case: a demographically still-agrarian Gram Panchayat with a distinct local
- CAUTION: Parastatal water-board control persisting despite formal devolution of water supply to
- CAUTION: Full 3F devolution (Kerala-style) requires sustained political commitment across

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

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